USER GUIDE · ENGLISH

NOTA STUDIO (GW) User Guide

A music notation editor that runs in your web browser, with nothing to install.

Where to open it

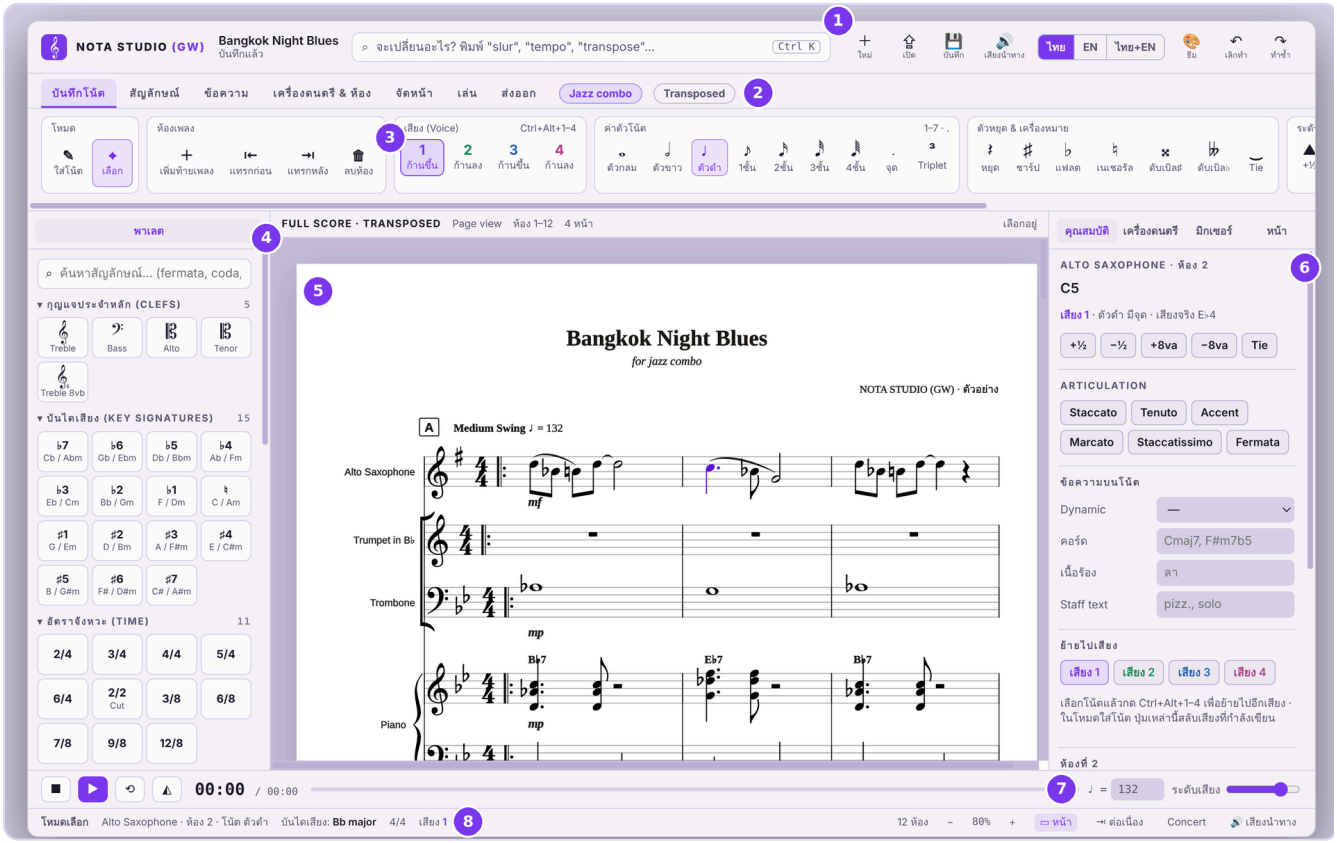
Web app (recommended)	wanlopn-spec.github.io/nota-studio
Claude link	claude.ai/artifact/Ci4e8RNpTBvfSUdFk1JF2M Adds reading notes from PDF and the Claude voice
Source code	github.com/wanlopn-spec/nota-studio

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1 Getting started

NOTA STUDIO (GW) runs in a web browser: open the link and start writing. Chrome or Edge on a computer is recommended, because most commands have keyboard shortcuts. The first time you open it you will see the sample score “Bangkok Night Blues”; press `Space` to hear it.

> **Interface language** The app's buttons and menus are in Thai. This guide uses English names and gives the Thai label in brackets where it helps you find the control, for example **Save (บันทึก)**. The spoken guide (section 11) can read every control aloud in English.



The main window of NOTA STUDIO (GW) in the purple and white theme

1. **Top bar** command search (`Ctrl+K`), new, open, save, spoken guide, language buttons, theme, undo, redo
2. **Menu tabs** Write, Notations, Text, Instruments & measures, Layout, Play, Export
3. **Tool ribbon** the commands of the selected tab
4. **Palettes** clefs, key and time signatures, and symbols, with a search box
5. **Score** where you write and edit music
6. **Right panel** properties, instruments, mixer, and page settings
7. **Playback bar** play, stop, loop, metronome, tempo, volume
8. **Status bar** mode, selection, key, zoom, view, spoken guide

Saving: changes are kept automatically in that browser; press 💾 **Save (บันทึก)** or `Ctrl+S` to keep a file on your computer (section 9).

2 New scores and instruments

Press ＋ **New (ใหม่)** or `Ctrl+N`, pick a template, fill in the title, composer, key, time signature, tempo and number of measures, then press **Create score (สร้างสกอร์)**.

Template	Instruments
Solo piano	Piano
Lead sheet	Voice (add chord symbols yourself)
String quartet	Violin ×2, Viola, Cello
SATB choir	Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass, Piano
Jazz combo	Alto Sax, Trumpet, Trombone, Piano, Contrabass, Drum Set
Big band	Sax ×5, Trumpet ×4, Trombone ×4, Guitar, Piano, Bass, Drums
Rock band	Vocal, Electric Guitar ×2, Electric Bass, Drums
Orchestra	Fl, Ob, Cl, Bsn, Hn, Tpt, Tbn, Timpani, Vln ×2, Vla, Vc, Cb
Wind quintet	Fl, Ob, Cl, Hn, Bsn
Blank (ว่าง)	One flute

Adding, removing and reordering instruments

- **Add:** press `I`, or the Instruments & measures tab → ＋ **Add**, then search by name. There are 36 instruments; piano, organ and harp get two staves joined by a brace.
- **Rename, reorder, remove:** right panel, **Instruments (เครื่องดนตรี)** tab. Type a new name, use ↑ ↓ to reorder and ✕ to remove.
- Neighbouring instruments of the same family are bracketed automatically.

Transposing instruments and concert pitch

Trumpet in B♭, Alto Sax (E♭), Horn in F and other transposing instruments show the written pitch the player reads, while playback sounds at concert pitch. Click the **Transposed / Concert pitch** chip next to the tabs to switch. Concert pitch keeps the octave transposition of guitar, bass and piccolo.

3 Entering notes

Choose a duration, then type a note name A–G. The app picks the octave closest to the previous note, applies the key signature, and moves the cursor on.

1. Click the note or measure where you want to start.
2. Press `N` for note input. A purple cursor appears on the staff.
3. Press `1`–`7` to choose a duration, and `.` for a dotted note.
4. Type `A`–`G` to enter notes, or `0` for a rest.
5. Press `Esc` to leave note input.

Key	Duration	Key	Duration
`7`	Whole note	`3`	16th note
`6`	Half note	`2`	32nd note
`5`	Quarter note	`1`	64th note
`4`	Eighth note	`.`	Add / remove dot

Pitch, chords, ties and triplets

- `↑` `↓` move a semitone · `Ctrl+↑` `Ctrl+↓` move an octave · the ♯ ♭ ♮ 𝄪 𝄫 buttons set accidentals.
- `Shift` + a letter adds a note to the chord you just entered.
- `T` in note input adds a tied note of the same pitch; outside note input it turns a tie on or off.
- `Ctrl+3` turns on triplets: three notes in the time of two.
- A note longer than the rest of the measure is split and tied across the barline, and measures are added when you reach the end.
- **With the mouse:** in note input, click a line or space on the staff to place a note at that pitch.

4 Multiple voices

Each staff can hold up to four voices, for example a melody and a harmony line on one staff, or drums split into hands and feet.

Voice	Cursor color	Stems	Shortcut
1	Purple (theme color)	Up	`Ctrl+Alt+1`
2	Green	Down	`Ctrl+Alt+2`
3	Blue	Up	`Ctrl+Alt+3`
4	Dark pink	Down	`Ctrl+Alt+4`

- **Write voice 2:** press `N`, then `Ctrl+Alt+2` (or the Voice 2 button), and enter notes as usual.
- **Move a note to another voice:** outside note input, select the note and press `Ctrl+Alt+1`–`4`, or use **Move to voice (ย้ายไปเสียง)** in the properties panel.
- When voices 2–4 contain only rests for a whole measure, they disappear.

5 Selecting and editing

To select	Do this
One note	Click the note
A whole measure	Click an empty part of the measure
A range of notes	Select the first note, then `Shift`+click the last one, or `Shift+→`
Several measures or staves	Click the first measure, then `Shift`+click the last
The whole score	`Ctrl+A`

Move with `←` `→` by note, `Ctrl+←` `Ctrl+→` by measure, and `Alt+↑` `Alt+↓` to the staff above or below.

- `Ctrl+C` / `Ctrl+V` copy and paste notes or whole measures, including all voices.
- `Delete` turns the selected notes into rests or clears the selected measures · `Ctrl+Z` undo · `Ctrl+Y` redo.

Adding, inserting and deleting measures

Click any measure and a toolbar appears above it with **Insert before**, **Insert after** and **Delete measure**. After the last measure there is a round + button that adds a measure at the end. The same buttons are on the Write tab, the Instruments & measures tab and in the properties panel.

Shortcut	Command
`Ctrl+B`	Add a measure at the end
`Insert`	Insert a measure before the selection
`Ctrl+Insert`	Insert a measure after the selection
`Ctrl+Delete`	Delete the selected measures

Key, time signature, clef and transpose

- Select a measure, then click a key or time signature in the palette, or change it in the properties panel, to change it mid-score.
- Clefs (treble, bass, alto, tenor, treble 8vb): select a note on that staff and click the clef in the palette.
- **Transpose:** Instruments & measures tab. Choose direction, interval and scope. Chord symbols move too; the drum set does not.

6 Symbols and text

Select a note or range, then click a symbol on the Notations tab or in the palette. Click again to remove it.

Group	Items	How
Articulation	Staccato, Tenuto, Accent, Marcato, Staccatissimo, Fermata	Select a note, then click
Dynamics	ppp – fff, sfz, fp, sf, rfz	Select a note, then click
Slur	Curved line over notes	Select a range, press `S`
Hairpin	Crescendo / Diminuendo	Select a range, press `<` / `>`
Barlines	Double, final, start repeat, end repeat	Select a measure, then click
Navigation	D.C. al Fine, D.S. al Coda, Fine, Segno, Coda	Select a measure, click in the palette

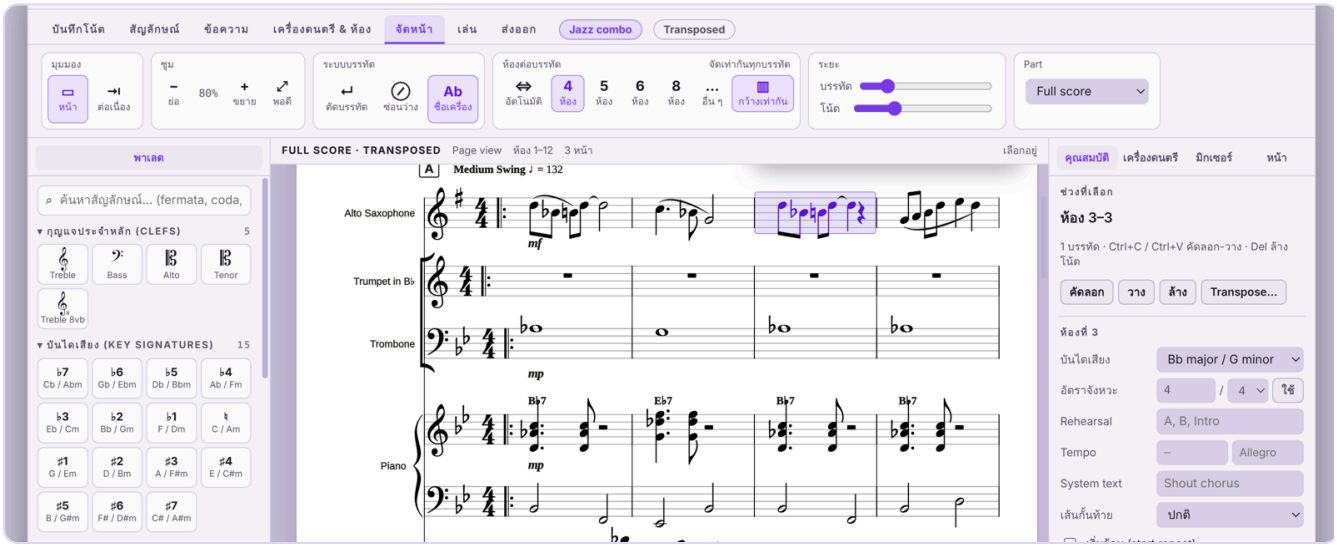
Text	Shortcut	Notes
Lyrics	`Ctrl+L`	`Space` or `Tab` moves to the next note, `-` splits syllables
Chord symbol	`Ctrl+Shift+K`	For example Cmaj7, F#m7b5 · `Space` moves on
Staff text	`Ctrl+T`	For example pizz., solo
Rehearsal mark	`Ctrl+M`	The next letter is suggested
Tempo	`Alt+T`	Type “Allegro 132” or “96”
Title, composer	Double-click the header	Or edit them in the right panel, **Page (หน้า)** tab

7 Layout and views

- **Views:** Page view or Continuous view.
- **Zoom:** `Ctrl+=` / `Ctrl+-`, or `Ctrl` + mouse wheel · **Fit** fills the window width.
- **System break:** select a measure and press `Enter`.
- **Hide empty staves** in each system except the first · **Part** shows one instrument on its own.
- **Spacing:** sliders for staff spacing, system spacing and note spacing.

The same number of measures on every line

On the **Layout (จัดหน้า)** tab, in “Measures per line”, choose **4 / 5 / 6 / 8** or **Other** (1–16). Every line then has that many measures. With **Equal widths** on, all measures are the same width and barlines line up like a lead sheet. Choose **Auto** to go back to spacing by content.

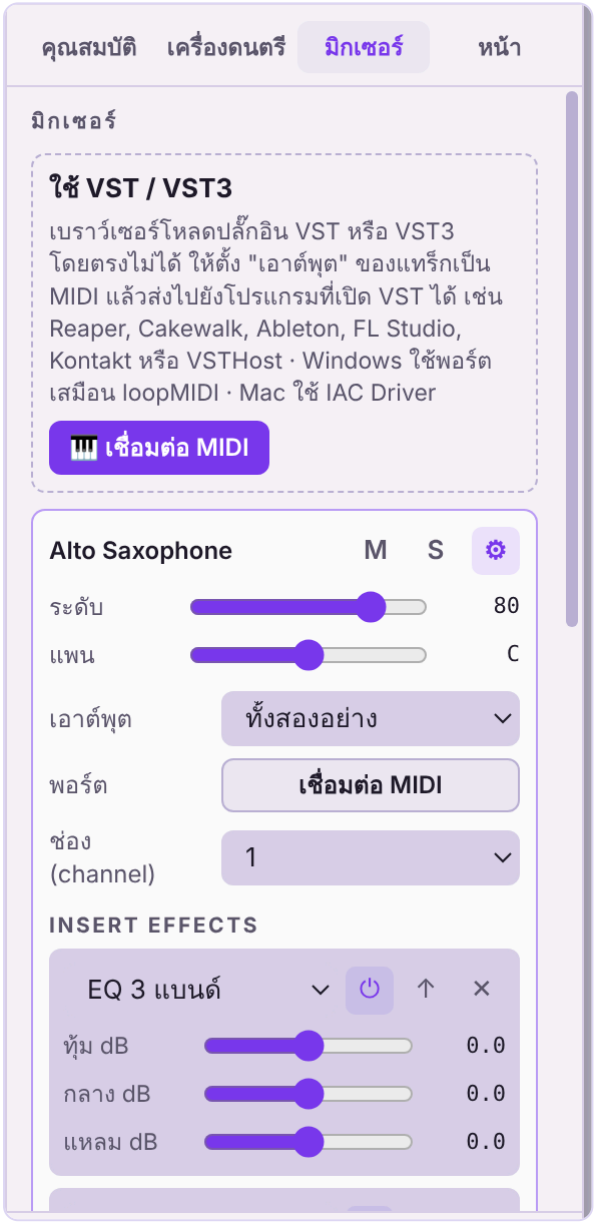


Four measures per line, and the measure toolbar above the selected measure

8 Playback and mixer

Press `Space` to play or stop. Playback starts at the selected measure, a playhead follows along, and repeats are played. The sound follows dynamics, accents, staccato, tenuto and ties.

Button	What it does
▶ / ■	Play / stop
⟲ Loop	Select several measures, then turn on to loop them
◭ Metronome	A click on every beat
Swing 8ths	Swing eighth notes (Play tab)
♩ =	The score's main tempo



Mixer: MIDI output and effects for a track

Mixer (right panel, Mixer tab)

- Every track has a volume slider, **M** (mute) and **S** (solo).
- Press ⚙ to open its settings: **pan**, **output** and **insert effects**.
- ＋ **Add effect** gives up to six slots per track: 3-band EQ, Compressor, Reverb, Delay, Chorus, Overdrive, Filter.
- Adjust each slot with sliders; ⏻ turns it on or off, ↑ moves it up, ✕ removes it.
- Volume, pan and effect settings change while playing. Adding or removing effects takes effect the next time you press play.

Using VST / VST3 through MIDI

A browser cannot load VST or VST3 plug-ins directly. Instead, send MIDI from a track to a program that hosts plug-ins, such as Reaper, Cakewalk, Ableton, FL Studio, Kontakt or VSTHost.

1. On Windows install **loopMIDI** (free) to create a virtual MIDI port. On a Mac, enable the **IAC Driver** in Audio MIDI Setup.
2. Open the web app in Chrome or Edge. In the right panel's **Mixer** tab press 🎹 **Connect MIDI** and allow access.
3. Press ⚙ on a track, set **Output** to “MIDI out (VST / DAW)” or “Both”, and choose the **port** and **channel**.
4. In your DAW, create a track that receives MIDI from the same port and channel, load a VST, and enable input monitoring.
5. Press play in NOTA STUDIO (GW). The notes sound through the VST, with timing, dynamics and swing.

> **Note** MIDI output works in the GitHub web app with Chrome or Edge on a computer; the Claude link usually blocks MIDI. A track set to MIDI out only does not use the in-app effects. You can also export a MIDI file (section 9) and open it in your DAW.

9 Save, open, import, export

Saving your work to your computer

- 💾 **Save (บันทึก)** or `Ctrl+S` writes `song-title.nota.json`, which keeps everything: notes, all voices, lyrics, chords, layout and mixer settings.
- **Save as** (`Ctrl+Shift+S`) saves under a new name.
- **Open (เปิด)** or `Ctrl+O` opens a `.nota.json` file so you can keep editing. You can also drag the file onto the score.
- In the GitHub web app with Chrome or Edge, later `Ctrl+S` presses overwrite the same file. Other browsers and the Claude link download a new file each time.
- Under the title in the top-left, the status shows, for example, “saved to computer 20:37” or “not saved to computer yet”.

Import

- **MusicXML** (.musicxml, .xml, .mxl) from MuseScore, Sibelius, Finale or Dorico, including several voices per staff.
- **PDF or sheet-music images** (Export tab → “PDF / image → listen”): Claude reads the notes and you press “▶ Play now”. This works only in the Claude link, reads up to 12 pages, and accuracy depends on how clear the file is.

Export (Export tab)

Button	File	Use it to
Everything .zip	MusicXML + MIDI + SVG + project	Keep a complete set
MusicXML	.musicxml (inside a .zip in the Claude link)	Continue in another notation program
MIDI	.mid (inside a .zip in the Claude link)	Open in a DAW with VSTs · includes volume and pan per track
SVG / PNG	One image per page	Print, add to documents, share
Copy MusicXML	Text on the clipboard	Paste into a .musicxml file yourself

10 Color themes

The default theme is **purple and white**. Press 🎨 **Theme (ธีม)** in the top bar to pick one of 11 preset themes (Purple-white, MuBiTo orange, Midnight, Forest, Rose, Violet, Graphite, High contrast, Daylight, Ocean, Mint), or set your own dark or light mode, accent color, background tone and paper color. Changes apply at once and are remembered in that browser; “Reset to default” returns to purple and white.

11 Spoken guide (blind and low-vision users)

The spoken guide reads aloud where the mouse or cursor is and which control or note it points at, so people who are blind or have low vision can write music without looking at the screen. It can speak **Thai**, **English**, or **both**.

Turning it on and choosing a language

- Press 🔊 **Spoken guide (เสียงนำทาง)** or `F2`. Screen-reader users who press `Tab` first land on a button that turns it on.
- Use the **ไทย | EN | ไทย+EN** buttons in the top bar, or `Ctrl+F2`, to switch language.
- More settings (voices, speed, what to read): the "🔊" button at the far right of the status bar.

What it says

- Pointing at a control: "button, Note input, shortcut N".
- Pointing at or moving to a note: "D 5 eighth note, Alto Saxophone, measure 1, beat 1".
- Entering a note: "Entered C 5 quarter note"; also mode, duration and voice changes, play and stop, and notifications.



Spoken guide settings

Shortcut	What it does
`F2`	Turn the spoken guide on or off
`Ctrl+F2`	Change language: Thai → English → Thai + English
`Shift+F2`	Hear your position and the current state
`F6` or `F8`	Move to the next area of the screen (`Shift` to go back)
`Tab` / arrows	Move between buttons in the same area
`Esc`	Return to the score

Voices English voices are built into almost every computer. A Thai voice comes with macOS ("Kanya"); on Windows add one in Settings → Time & language → Speech → Add voices. The browser starts speaking after you click or press a key on the page once.

12 Keyboard shortcuts

Press `Ctrl+K` to search every command by name. On a Mac use `Cmd` instead of `Ctrl`.

Shortcut	Command
`N`	Note input
`Esc`	Leave / clear selection
`A` – `G`	Enter a note
`Shift` + `A` – `G`	Add to chord
`1` – `7`	Duration
`.`	Dot
`0`	Rest
`Ctrl+3`	Triplet
`↑` `↓`	Semitone
`Ctrl+↑` `Ctrl+↓`	Octave
`Ctrl+Alt+1` – `4`	Voice 1–4
`T`	Tie
`S`	Slur
`<` `>`	Crescendo / Diminuendo
`←` `→`	Previous / next note
`Ctrl+←` `Ctrl+→`	Previous / next measure
`Alt+↑` `Alt+↓`	Staff above / below
`Ctrl+L`	Lyrics
`Ctrl+Shift+K`	Chord symbol
`Ctrl+T`	Staff text

Shortcut	Command
`Ctrl+M`	Rehearsal mark
`Alt+T`	Tempo
`Enter`	System break
`Ctrl+B`	Add measure at end
`Insert`	Insert measure before
`Ctrl+Insert`	Insert measure after
`Ctrl+Delete`	Delete measures
`Delete`	Delete notes / clear
`Ctrl+C` `Ctrl+V`	Copy / paste
`Ctrl+A`	Select all
`Ctrl+Z` `Ctrl+Y`	Undo / redo
`I`	Add instrument
`Space`	Play / stop
`Ctrl+=` `Ctrl+-`	Zoom in / out
`Ctrl+S`	Save to computer
`Ctrl+Shift+S`	Save as
`Ctrl+O`	Open file
`Ctrl+N`	New score
`F2`	Spoken guide

13 Limitations and FAQ

Not available yet

- Grace notes, ottava (8va), pedal marks, volta brackets, multi-measure rests, guitar tablature and chord diagrams.
- Handwriting input, and direct PDF export (use SVG or PNG).
- Loading VST / VST3 plug-ins inside the app (send MIDI to a DAW instead; see section 8).
- Hiding individual rests in voices 2–4; dynamics and lyrics of several voices at the same beat may overlap.

Frequently asked questions

My work is missing on another computer. The automatic copy lives only in the browser where you made it. Save a file (`Ctrl+S`) and open it on the other computer.

How do I get the sample score back? Press `Ctrl+K` and choose “Load sample score”. You can still press `Ctrl+Z` to return to your score.

There is no sound. Click once on the page before pressing play, and check the track is not muted or set to MIDI out only.

Transposed notes don't match what I hear. That is written pitch, as expected. Turn on concert pitch to see sounding pitch.

I don't see a new feature. Reload with `Ctrl+Shift+R`.

Shortcuts don't work. Click on the score first; shortcuts are off while the cursor is in a text field.